

In the market we've had since 1980 the stalwarts have been good performers, but not the star performers. Most of these are huge companies, and it's unusual to get a tenbagger out of a Bristol-Myers or a Coca-Cola. So if you own a stalwart like Bristol-Myers and the stock's gone up 50 percent in a year or two, you have to wonder if maybe that's enough and begin to think about selling. How much can you expect to squeeze out of Colgate-Palmolive? You aren't going to become a millionaire off it the way you could have with Subaru, unless there is some startling new development you would have heard about by now.

Fifty percent in two years is what you'd be delighted to get from Colgate-Palmolive in most normal situations. With the stalwarts you have to consider taking profits more readily than you would with a Shoney's, or a Service Corporation International. Stalwarts are stocks that I generally buy for a 30 to 50 percent gain, then sell and repeat the process with similar issues that haven't yet appreciated.